Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH **0500/01**

Paper 1 Reading **For examination from 2027**

MARK SCHEME

Maximum Mark: 80

Converted

This mark scheme accompanies a converted question paper: Cambridge IGCSE First Language English 0500/11 October/November 2024, restructured to the 2027–2029 Paper 1 format. The reading texts in the insert are unchanged.

Where a question has been carried over, the indicative content is transferred unchanged, because the text has not changed and the creditable points have not changed. Questions marked **generated** are new and their indicative content has been written for this conversion.

Level descriptor tables are reproduced unchanged from the official 2027 specimen mark scheme (0500/01/SP/27). Conversion decisions are recorded in the note on page 4.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Generic Marking Principles

All examiners must apply these general marking principles when marking candidate responses. Examiners must apply them alongside the specific content of the mark scheme or generic level descriptions for a question. Each question paper and mark scheme must also comply with these marking principles.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 1:

Marks must be awarded in line with:

- the specific content of the mark scheme or the generic level descriptions for the question
- the specific skills defined in the mark scheme or in the generic level descriptions for the question
- the standard of response required by a candidate as exemplified by the standardisation scripts.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 2:

Marks awarded are always whole marks (not half marks, or other fractions).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 3:

Marks must be awarded positively:

- marks are awarded for correct/valid answers, as defined in the mark scheme. However, credit is given for valid answers which go beyond the scope of the syllabus and mark scheme, referring to your Team Leader as appropriate
- marks are awarded when candidates clearly demonstrate what they know and can do
- marks are not deducted for errors
- marks are not deducted for omissions
- answers should only be judged on the quality of spelling, punctuation and grammar when these features are specifically assessed by the question as indicated by the mark scheme. The meaning, however, should be unambiguous.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 4:

Rules must be applied consistently, e.g. in situations where candidates have not followed instructions or in the application of generic level descriptions.

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 5:

Marks should be awarded using the full range of marks defined in the mark scheme for the question (however, the use of the full mark range may be limited according to the quality of the candidate responses seen).

GENERIC MARKING PRINCIPLE 6:

Marks awarded are based solely on the requirements as defined in the mark scheme. Marks should not be awarded with grade thresholds or grade descriptions in mind.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

English & Media-Specific Marking Principles

(To be read in conjunction with the Generic Marking Principles (and requiring further guidance on how to place marks within levels))

Components using level descriptions:

- We use level descriptions as a guide to broad understanding of the qualities normally expected of, or typical of, work in a level.
- Level descriptions are a means of general guidance, and should not be interpreted as hurdle statements.
- Where indicative content notes are supplied for a question, these are not a prescription of required content, and must not be treated as such. Alternative correct points and unexpected answers in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the knowledge and skills demonstrated.
- While we may have legitimate expectations as to the ground most answers may occupy, we must at all times be prepared to meet candidates on their chosen ground, provided it is relevant ground (e.g. clearly related to and derived from a relevant passage/text and meeting the mark scheme requirements for the question).

Components using point-based marking:

Point marking is often used to reward knowledge, understanding and application of skills. We give credit where the candidate's answer shows relevant knowledge, understanding and application of skills in answering the question. We do not give credit where the answer shows confusion.

From this it follows that we:

a DO credit answers which are worded differently from the mark scheme if they clearly convey the same meaning (unless the mark scheme requires a specific term).

b DO credit alternative answers/examples which are not written in the mark scheme if they are correct.

c DO credit answers where candidates give more than one correct answer in one prompt/numbered/scaffolded space where extended writing is required rather than list-type answers. For example, questions that require n reasons (e.g. State two reasons …).

d DO NOT credit answers simply for using a 'key term' unless that is all that is required. (Check for evidence it is understood and not used incorrectly.)

e DO NOT credit answers which are obviously self-contradicting or trying to cover all possibilities.

f DO NOT give further credit for what is effectively repetition of a correct point already credited unless the language itself is being tested. This applies equally to 'mirror statements' (i.e. polluted/not polluted).

g DO NOT require spellings to be correct, unless this is part of the test. However spellings of syllabus terms must allow for clear and unambiguous separation from other syllabus terms with which they may be confused (e.g. Corrasion/Corrosion).

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Notes on this converted mark scheme

Question 1 order. Sub-parts run in the order of their anchors in Text A. Generated items were interleaved by anchor, not appended. The R3 item on the queen (¶2) follows old 1(b)(ii) (line 5, ¶2) as 1(c), so old 1(c) becomes 1(d). The R4 item on 'The cycle of a plant's life keeps turning' (¶4, line 12) sits between old 1(d)(i) (pollination, ¶4) and old 1(d)(ii) (human benefits, ¶5) as 1(e)(ii), so old 1(d) becomes 1(e)(i) and 1(e)(iii), and old 1(e) becomes 1(f). Six letters, (a)–(f), as in the specimen. The new 1(c) shares ¶2 with 1(b)(ii) but is not grouped under 1(b), because 1(b)'s lead ('explain what the text means by') does not fit it; this follows the precedent of the m24 conversion.

Question 3 mark split. This paper follows the specimen allocation exactly: 3(a) 2 × 1, 3(b) 3 × 1, 3(c) 5, 3(d) 10, totalling 20.

The source 2(a) carried four one-mark identification items and the 2027 3(a) has room for two. Kept 2(a)(i) 'optimism' (R1) and 2(a)(ii) 'painstaking' (R2), so the pair spans explicit and implicit retrieval. The items not carried forward are:

- 2(a)(iii) make his range of smoothies more varied → '(to) diversify (his range of smoothies)' (line 29), R1
- 2(a)(iv) look very thoughtfully at → '(the two men / they) contemplate (the bees)' (line 47), R1

Question 3(d). The 2027 language task prints a single extract and names a specific focus, where the source 2(d) referenced two paragraphs. Kept: paragraph 5, 'The delicate tracery …' (the bees and the acacia trees in Damian's field), printed in full; 12 indicative entries carried. Dropped: paragraph 11, 'A worker bee swung …' (the bee in the kitchen) and its 10 indicative entries and overview.

- 2(a) and 4 use the specimen mark line ('Up to 10 marks are available for reading and up to N marks for writing') in place of the 2024 wording, matching the specimen and the existing converted papers.
- 3(c) stem adapted to the specimen shape ('explain how the writer uses language to suggest …'); the 2024 stem read 'explain how the writer suggests the thoughts and feelings of Damian …'. The focus is unchanged. 3(c) was 3 marks with point-banded guidance; it is now 5 marks on specimen Table D. Its old 3/2/1 award rules no longer apply; indicative content is unchanged.
- 3(a)/3(b): underlining converted to bold; 'words underlined' becomes 'words in bold'.
- 4: word count 250–350 → 250–300; marks 15 reading + 10 writing → 10 + 10. The journal form is on the 2027 list.

Table substitutions. Tables A, B, C, D, E, F and G below are taken unchanged from the official 2027 specimen mark scheme 0500/01/SP/27. No table has been reworded or rescaled.

Generated questions. 1(c), 1(e(ii)), 2(b) are new to this conversion. Each was tested for answerability against the insert alone before its indicative content was written. 2(b) targets the writer's attitude, so it cannot be answered from content already creditable in the 2(a) summary.

Insert. Insert passed through unchanged. Its 'Read Text X, and then answer Question …' cue lines still carry the 2024 question numbers (1(a)–(e), 1(f), 2(a)–(d) and 3); the conversion prompt forbids editing the insert, so candidates should be told the cue lines are superseded by the question paper. Text C line 37 ('I was thinking of pizza …') ends with an ellipsis glyph that does not extract from the PDF; it is unaffected because no converted question quotes it.

Source discrepancies.

- The 2024 mark scheme heads old 1(e) 'Re-read paragraph 5 ('But bees … costing us all.')'; the question paper and insert make this paragraph 6. The question-paper wording is used.
- The 2024 mark scheme quotes the 1(d) lead as '… subject of study'; the question paper and insert read 'subject to study'. The question-paper wording is used.
- The spelling 'Adbul' in the 2024 mark scheme's Question 3 A2 notes is transferred verbatim, as the conversion rules require.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Note: All examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the texts.

Question 1

This question tests reading assessment objectives R1, R2, R3, R4 and R5 (20 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text

R4 demonstrate understanding of how writers achieve effects and influence readers

R5 select and use information for specific purposes.

Overview of items for Question 1

Item	Assessment objectives tested	Marks for assessment objectives
1(a)	R5	1
1(b)(i)	R1 and R2	2
1(b)(ii)	R1 and R2	2
1(c)	R2 and R3 *(generated)*	3
1(d)	R1	2
1(e)(i)	R1 and R5	2
1(e)(ii)	R4 *(generated)*	2
1(e)(iii)	R1, R2 and R5	3
1(f)	R1 and R2	3
Total		**20**

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
1(a)	**Which bee is the biggest in a colony, according to paragraph 1?** Award 1 mark for: • queen (bee)	1
1(b)(i)	**Using your own words, explain what the text means by:** **'special diet' (line 3)** Award 2 marks for full explanation (both strands). Award 1 mark for partial explanation. Credit alternatives explaining the whole phrase. • distinctive / different / particular / specific / just for her / tailored (to her needs) / unique • food / nourishment / nutrition / meal(s) / alimentation	2
1(b)(ii)	**Using your own words, explain what the text means by:** **'sole purpose' (line 5).** Award 2 marks for full explanation (both strands). Award 1 mark for partial explanation. Credit alternatives explaining the whole phrase. • solitary / only / single / unique / their one • reason for existence / job / role / function / use / task / objective / aim / intention / motivation / goal	2
1(c)	**Re-read paragraph 2 ('The queen is ... hive continues.').** **Using your own words, explain why the writer suggests that the whole colony revolves around the queen.** Award 1 mark for each idea, predominantly in own words, up to a maximum of 3. Answers which are entirely in the words of the text should not be credited. Credit the drone point only where it is linked to the queen (e.g. the males exist only to breed with her), not where it simply repeats the meaning of 'sole purpose' already credited in 1(b)(ii). • she is the parent of every bee in the hive / all the workers and all the males are her offspring ('mother of all the workers and also the male drones') • she is kept safe / protected within the hive rather than going out herself ('She remains inside') • the workers devote themselves to her care / wait on her like servants, cleaning her and bringing her food ('attended by the workers who groom and feed her') • the males exist for one reason only – to breed with her ('The sole purpose of the drone is to mate with her') • the colony's survival / future depends on her producing young ('so that the hive continues')	3
1(d)	**Re-read paragraph 3 ('Bees have different ... deep inside them.').** **Give two characteristics that make the early bumblebee and the garden bumblebee different.** Award 1 mark for each idea, up to a maximum of 2. • size / early bumble bee is small(er) / garden bumblebee is large(r) • length of tongues / garden bumblebee has a long(er) tongue / early bumblebee has a short(er) tongue • agility / the early bumblebee is (more) agile	2
1(e)(i)	**Re-read paragraphs 4 and 5 ('Plants can ... subject to study.').** **Identify two ways in which bee pollination is needed for plants.** Award 1 mark for each idea, up to a maximum of 2. • Growth • Reproduction • (enable plant to produce) food	2

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
1(e)(ii)	**Re-read paragraphs 4 and 5 ('Plants can ... subject to study.').** **Explain the effect of the phrase 'The cycle of a plant's life keeps turning' (line 12).** Award 1 mark for each idea, up to a maximum of 2. A response that only restates the literal meaning (plants keep reproducing) should be awarded a maximum of 1 mark. • presents a plant's life as a wheel / circle going round and round – growth, reproduction and new plants follow one another in a repeating pattern • 'keeps' suggests something continuous / never-ending, so nature seems steady and dependable • makes the process sound natural, smooth and regular / like a mechanism kept running • 'in this way' ties the turning to the bees' pollination – the cycle depends on bees and would stop / break down without them • prepares the reader for the warning in paragraph 6 that bees are 'in trouble' – if bees decline, the whole cycle is threatened	2
1(e)(iii)	**Re-read paragraphs 4 and 5 ('Plants can ... subject to study.').** **Explain how humans have benefited from the existence of bees.** • range of food / different foods / fruits, coffee and vanilla / appealing foods • cotton (clothing) / natural clothing materials / natural fabrics • education / science / the arts / studying them	3
1(f)	**Re-read paragraph 6 ('But bees ... costing us all.').** **Why might some humans disregard the threats to bees?** Award 1 mark for each idea, predominantly in own words, up to a maximum of 3. Answers which are entirely in the words of the text should not be credited. • not aware of how human decisions impact on bees / do not know that bees are threatened • food production is prioritised / want food to be readily available / want safe food / farmers need to produce food / need to use pesticides • need to build (more) houses / need to expand towns / need for urbanisation • selfish / thoughtless / only thinking about themselves / focused on human desires / consider only human needs • do not realise threats to bees (will) affect humans too	3

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Note: All examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the texts.

Question 2

Question 2(a) tests the following reading assessment objectives (10 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R5 select and use information for specific purposes.

This question also tests the following writing assessment objectives (5 marks):

W1 articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined

W2 organise and structure facts, ideas and opinions for effect

W3 use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context.

Question 2(b) tests the following reading assessment objectives (5 marks):

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text.

Overview of items for Question 2

Item	Assessment objectives tested	Marks for assessment objectives
2(a)	R1, R2 and R5	10
	W1, W2 and W3	5
2(b)	R2 and R3 *(generated)*	5
Total		**20**

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
2(a)	**According to Text B, what should people consider and do before taking up beekeeping?** **You must use continuous writing (not note form) and use your own words as far as possible.** **Your summary should not be more than 120 words.** **Up to 10 marks are available for reading and up to 5 marks for writing.** Use the Marking Criteria for Question 2(a) (Table A, Reading and Table B, Writing). **INDICATIVE READING CONTENT** Candidates may refer to any of the points below: • 1 the reasons why they want to keep bees • 2 whether they want the hard work / if they are ready for the responsibility of looking after bees • 3 whether they are allowed to keep bees in their area / any local restrictions on beekeeping • 4 (seeking) help from bee keeping organisation(s) / expert advice / researching (online) • 5 appropriate clothing / protective clothing / full beekeeping suit and gloves • 6 you might be stung • 7 what their neighbours might think / neighbours may object • 8 appropriate location for the hives (allow example: flat / sheltered / in the sunlight by day / accessible) • 9 weight of the hive / practicality of the hive • 10 bees cannot be left alone for long • 11 someone suitable to look after the bees when they are away • 12 cost implications / that beekeeping can be expensive / only buying what you need	15

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Marking criteria for Question 2(a)

Table A, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2 and R5.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• An effective response that demonstrates understanding of a wide range of relevant ideas and is consistently well-focused on the text and task. • Relevant ideas are skilfully selected to demonstrate an overview.
4	7–8	• A mostly effective response that demonstrates a competent understanding of a good range of relevant ideas and is consistently well-focused on the text and task. • Relevant ideas are carefully selected and there is some evidence of an overview.
3	5–6	• A partially effective response that demonstrates understanding of a range of relevant ideas with occasional loss of focus on text or task. • Some evidence of selection of relevant ideas but may include excess material.
2	3–4	• A basic response that demonstrates general understanding of relevant ideas and is sometimes focused on text and task. • Some indiscriminate selection of ideas.
1	1–2	• A response that demonstrates limited understanding of relevant ideas and shows limited focus on text and task. • Little evidence of selection of ideas.
0	0	No creditable content.

Table B, Writing

Use the following table to give a mark out of 5 for Writing. This question tests assessment objectives W1, W2 and W3.

Level	Marks	Description
3	4–5	• Expression is clear and fluent. • Organisation is effective. • Concise use of a range of appropriate vocabulary.
2	2–3	• Expression is generally clear. • Organisation is sometimes effective. • Areas of concision but some reliance on the words of the text.
1	1	• Expression lacks clarity. • Organisation is limited. • Includes lifted sections.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
2(b)	**Assess the writer's attitude towards beekeeping.** **Use three details from Text B to support your answer.** Use the Marking Criteria for Question 2(b) (Table C, Reading). Credit is for identifying the writer's attitude and supporting it from the text, not for retrieving the practical advice already creditable in 2(a). Credit any other attitude that is valid and supported. Responses might use the following: • challenging / questioning – wants readers to examine their motives and treats beekeeping as a serious undertaking rather than a whim (paragraph 1): the string of rhetorical questions 'Why be a beekeeper? Is it because you like honey?'; 'a considerable responsibility' • tolerant and good-humoured towards other beekeepers, but sceptical about much of the advice on offer (paragraph 3): 'presumably because the beekeepers were all out and about pursuing their hobby'; 'anecdotal'; 'rather than of use to me' • self-mocking / candid about the writer's own naivety as a beginner (paragraph 4): 'Naturally, I assumed'; 'spacesuit-like'; 'Yes, it's happened to me' • affectionate towards the bees, treating them as residents whose needs matter (paragraph 6): 'their stripy occupants' • rueful – has learnt the hard way and can laugh at past mistakes, while still caring for the bees (paragraph 7): 'my aching back taught me'; 'intending to give my bees a robust and safe home' (see also paragraph 9: 'a few expensive purchasing errors')	5

Table C, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 5 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R2 and R3.

Level	Marks	Description
3	4–5	Clear understanding of the writer's attitude with relevant support from the text.
2	2–3	Some understanding of the writer's attitude with some supporting detail.
1	1	Limited understanding of the writer's attitude.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Note: All examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the texts.

Question 3

This question tests reading assessment objectives R1, R2 and R4 (20 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R4 demonstrate understanding of how writers achieve effects and influence readers.

Overview of items for Question 3

Item	Assessment objectives tested	Marks for assessment objectives
3(a)(i)	R1	1
3(a)(ii)	R2	1
3(b)(i)	R2	1
3(b)(ii)	R2	1
3(b)(iii)	R1	1
3(c)	R1, R2 and R4	5
3(d)	R1, R2 and R4	10
Total		**20**

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
3(a)(i)	**Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words in bold:** **Abdul does not feel the same confidence about the future as Damian.** Accept cloze responses that repeat all / some of the question stem with the correct answer. • (Damian's / his) optimism (line 4)	1
3(a)(ii)	**Abdul shared his very thorough research with Damian.** Accept cloze responses that repeat all / some of the question stem with the correct answer. • (his) painstaking (line 23)	1
3(b)(i)	**Using your own words, explain what the writer means by each of the words in bold:** A few months earlier, Damian and Abdul had been **relaxing** in Damian's field, near his beehives. It had been the first **mild** morning for many months and the two men were **sipping** Damian's home-made acacia honey and berry smoothies. **relaxing** • relaxing: unwinding, sitting comfortably, taking time out, chilling, resting, lounging	1
3(b)(ii)	**mild** • mild: not too hot / not too cold, cool(er) / warm(er), pleasant (weather), agreeable, temperate, calm, nice	1
3(b)(iii)	**sipping** • sipping: (taking) small mouthfuls, drinking (a little bit at a time)	1

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
3(c)	**Use one example from the text below to explain how the writer uses language to suggest Damian's thoughts and feelings about running his own business.** **Use your own words in your explanation.** 'I agree with that little bee,' announced Damian, smacking his lips in pleasure at the taste of honey and berries. 'We should venture out of our own hives and taste the sweet nectar of life. Get ahead of the crowd. Nice big shop in the middle of town.' Use the Marking Criteria for Question 3(c) (Table D, Reading). The explanation must be predominantly in the candidate's own words. Responses might use the following: • 'I agree with that little bee,' announced Damian: relates to the small bee as brave; affectionate; dramatic, theatrical, (deliberately) eccentric • smacking his lips in pleasure: opens and closes his mouth noisily; reflects his enjoyment of the smoothie but also how Damian relishes the idea of an exciting business future; self-congratulatory • venture out of our own hives and taste the sweet nectar of life: leave their comfort zone; excited about the future; wants to take chances, be independent; casual risk-taker; romanticised, idealised view; nectar is the food of Gods / Queen so sees them reaching great heights and wallowing in the fruits of their hard work • Get ahead of the crowd: wants to be a leader; feels competitive; wants recognition; resists being ordinary, suggests arrogance / overly ambitious; like a race • Nice big shop in the middle of town: imagines success without thinking carefully; huge size of shop, central location; ambitious; big dreams; life of grandeur and significance; shop and location indicative of material success he wishes for; superficial desire to be at the centre.	5

Table D, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 5 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2 and R4.

Level	Marks	Description
3	4–5	Clear understanding of the writer's use of language.
2	2–3	Some understanding of the writer's use of language.
1	1	Limited understanding of the writer's use of language.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
3(d)	**Choose three powerful words or phrases from the extract below to analyse how the writer uses language to describe the bees and the acacia trees in Damian's field.** 'The delicate tracery of acacia leaves cast a dancing dappled shade over the beehives. A worker bee, one of the first to venture uncertainly out of the hive that morning, drew dizzy spirals in the air, as it orientated itself, sensing the nectar in the newly budding flowers. Damian could faintly hear the drones inside the hive humming in reverential attendance on their queen. He looked up. Any day now those acacia trees would burst into flower and cascades of clustered white blossom would turn the trees silver. Then this solitary worker would be accompanied by hundreds of other labourers, all intent on drinking their fill of nectar.' Write about 200 to 250 words. Use the Marking Criteria for Question 3(d) (Table E, Reading). **Notes on the task** This question is marked for the ability to select powerful or unusual words and for an understanding of ways in which the language is effective. Expect responses to provide words / phrases that carry connotations additional to general meaning. Mark holistically for the overall quality of the response, not for the number of words chosen, bearing in mind that for the higher bands there should be a range of choices to demonstrate an understanding of how language works, and that this should include the ability to explain images. It is the quality of the analysis that attracts marks. Do not deduct marks for inaccurate statements; simply ignore them. The following notes are a guide to what good responses might say about the selections. Candidates can make any sensible comment, but only credit those that are relevant to the correct meanings of the words in the context and that have some validity. Alternative acceptable explanations should be credited. Credit comments on effects created by non-vocabulary choices such as grammar / syntax and punctuation devices. These must be additional to comments on vocabulary. Only credit comments on stylistic effect where these are explicitly linked to choices.	10

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
3(d)	Responses might focus on words or phrases from the following: • delicate tracery: fine, intricate, fragile decorative patterns; artistic design • (cast a) dancing dappled shade: area covered in spots of soft light and dark colour; sunlight making patterns through the leaves of the tree; reciprocal relationship between bees, tree and sunlight • venture uncertainly: set off on a journey without confidence; a bit fearful; on an important mission/quest • drew dizzy spirals in the air: made circular shapes as it moved in the air; unsteadying; spinning; confusing to watch; bee trying to get its bearings; going nowhere • orientated: using clues from its surroundings to find its direction; worked out where it was going • sensing (the nectar in the) newly budding flowers: detecting (the nectar in the) young blooms/blossoms; machine-like; programmed; instinctive response; suggestion of promise • humming in reverential attendance: low pitched continuous noise in admiration and respect as they wait on the queen; subservience; treat her like real royalty • burst into flower: erupt into blossom; suddenness; arrive when not expected; imminent; spectacle • cascades of clustered (white blossom): large bunches of petals tumble down amongst the tree branches, like a waterfall; plentiful, abundance • turn the trees silver: make the trees look shiny; as if turning something natural into a precious metal; ornamental • solitary worker would be accompanied by hundreds of other labourers: isolated bee; working by herself; industrious; dedicated to cause; many working fellow bees; all pulling together • all intent on drinking their fill of nectar: very focused on what they are doing; know their roles; satiating hunger; purposeful	

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Marking Criteria for Question 3(d)

Table E, Reading: Analysing how writers achieve effects

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2 and R4.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• Analysis adds meaning and associations to precisely selected words/phrases and demonstrates the writer's reasons for using them. • Explains images with some precision and imagination. • Clear understanding of the writer's use of language.
4	7–8	• Some analysis of carefully selected words and phrases offers secure explanations of meanings within the context of the text. • Begins to identify and explain images. • Some understanding of the writer's use of language.
3	5–6	• Chooses appropriate words and phrases. • Mostly explains meanings of words. • Attempts to suggest and explain effects are basic or general.
2	3–4	• Chooses words and phrases that communicate less effectively within the context of the text. • Explanations repeat the language of the original and/or are general, slight or only partially effective. • Correctly identifies linguistic devices.
1	1–2	• Choice of words is rarely relevant. • Comments offer limited evidence of understanding.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Note: All examiners are instructed that alternative correct answers and unexpected approaches in candidates' scripts must be given marks that fairly reflect the relevant knowledge and skills demonstrated. Nonetheless, the content must be clearly related to and derived from the texts.

Question 4

This question tests reading assessment objectives R1, R2, R3 and R5 (10 marks):

R1 demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings

R2 demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes

R3 analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text

R5 select and use information for specific purposes.

and writing assessment objectives W1, W2, W3 and W4 (10 marks):

W1 articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined

W2 organise and structure facts, ideas and opinions for effect

W3 use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context

W4 use language appropriate to audience and purpose.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
4	**You are Abdul. At the end of your first day selling smoothies at the market, you write a journal entry in which you reflect on your experiences.** **In your journal entry you should:** • **explain the most important considerations you had when wanting to set up the business** • **explain your thoughts and feelings about your business partner, Damian, and the advantages and drawbacks of being in business together** • **describe how you see your business developing in the future and any concerns you may have.** **Write the words of the journal entry.** **Write about 250 to 300 words.** **Up to 10 marks are available for reading and up to 10 marks for writing.** Use the Marking Criteria for Question 4 (Table F, Reading and Table G, Writing). **Notes on the task** Candidates should select ideas from the text (see below) and develop them relevantly, supporting what they write with details from the text. Look for an appropriate register for the genre, and a clear and balanced response which covers the three areas of the question, is well sequenced, and is in the candidate's own words. Annotate A1 for references to the most important considerations you had when wanting to set up the business Annotate A2 for references to your thoughts and feelings about your business partner, Damian, and the advantages and drawbacks of being in business together Annotate A3 for references to how you see your business developing in the future and any concerns you may have.	20

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Question	Answer	Marks
4	**A1: explain the most important considerations you had when wanting to set up the business** • making money (det. sold out on first day) [dev. needs to be profitable / support two people] • research (det. survey customers, online advice, price prepared to pay) [dev. needs to be thorough / need to know your market] • smoothies (det. fresh fruit, acacia honey, locally sourced) [dev. quality of product / natural product / honey is the product's 'USP' / delicious] • resources (det. fridge, freezer, van, packaging) [dev. initial outlay /need to build in purchase / take account of running costs] • venue to sell product (det. weekly market stall) [dev. trial period / save profits to gradually invest in more ambitious projects] • attract customers (det. cherry smoothies on offer) [dev. might make a loss at first / win customer approval] **A2: explain your thoughts and feelings about your business partner, Damian, and the advantages and drawbacks of being in business together** • Damian's creativity (det. makes product, talented) [dev. inventive / knows what people like / proved right / dedicated / Adbul more business orientated] • Damian's optimism (det. take double to sell next week) [dev. unrealistic / moving too quickly / encouraging / potential conflict] • Damian's relationship with bees (det. talks to them, observes them closely) [dev. treats them like human friends / whimsical] • good friends (det. since school) [dev. know each other well / comfortable around each other / knows how to deal with him / irritation] • teamwork (det. congratulating each other after first day) [dev. motivational / share burdens] **A3: describe how you see your business developing in the future and any concerns you may have** • (fear of) rivals (det. may copy business idea) [dev. may be dependent on Damian's creativity to fight off rivals / need to be unique / need to carefully watch market / more regular polls / market research to see what customers want] • permanent premises (det. (no other) shop in town, open every day) [dev. not sure he wants the change / enjoys life as it is now / possibility for the future / filling a gap in the market] • broadening product range (det. savoury, pizzas, different milks) [dev. unworkable idea and/or likely impact on the market / would need to invest in further resources and/or staff] • future of bees (det. currently living in Damian's field) [dev. practicalities / feels responsible for the bees' welfare / add to the hives] • environmental credentials (det. eco-friendly packaging, amount of packaging) [dev. natural product so should be (more) responsible / look for greener solutions]	

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Marking Criteria for Question 4

Table F, Reading

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Reading. This question tests assessment objectives R1, R2, R3 and R5.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• The response reveals a thorough evaluation and analysis of the text. • A wide range of ideas is applied. • Developed ideas are sustained and well related to the text. • There is supporting detail throughout, which is well integrated into the response, contributing to a strong sense of purpose and approach. • All three bullets are well covered. • A consistent and convincing voice is used.
4	7–8	• The response demonstrates a competent reading of the text with some evidence of basic evaluation or analysis. • A good range of ideas is evident. • Some ideas are developed but the ability to sustain them may not be consistent. • There is frequent, helpful supporting detail, contributing to a clear sense of purpose. • All three bullets are covered. • An appropriate voice is used.
3	5–6	• The response shows that the text has been read reasonably well. • A range of straightforward ideas is offered. • Opportunities for development are rarely taken. • Supporting detail is present but there may be some mechanical use of the text. • There is uneven focus on the bullets. • The voice is plain.
2	3–4	• There is some evidence of general understanding of the main ideas, but the response lacks focus on the text or the task. • Some brief, straightforward reference to the text is made. • There may be some reliance on lifting from the text. • Limited focus on the bullets. • The voice might be inappropriate.
1	1–2	• There is very limited evidence of engagement with the text. • Content is either insubstantial or unselective. • There is little realisation of the need to modify material from the text.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024

Table G, Writing

Use the following table to give a mark out of 10 for Writing. This question tests assessment objectives W1, W2, W3 and W4.

Level	Marks	Description
5	9–10	• Effective style. • Carefully structured for benefit of the reader. • Wide range of vocabulary, used with precision. • Effective use of language for audience and purpose.
4	7–8	• Sometimes effective style, mostly fluent and clear. • Ideas generally well sequenced. • Range of vocabulary, used with some precision. • Sometimes effective use of language for audience and purpose.
3	5–6	• Clear, plain style. • Relies on the sequence of the original text. • Range of vocabulary is adequate. • Some awareness of audience and purpose.
2	3–4	• Inconsistent style, expression sometimes awkward. • Response is not well sequenced. • Vocabulary is simple, limited in range or reliant on the original text. • Limited awareness of audience and purpose.
1	1–2	• Expression unclear. • Very brief and undeveloped. • Copies sections from the original text. • Little attempt to explain ideas.
0	0	No creditable content.

© Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2024